

Thaddeus Liu

Technical & Programmatic SEO Lead · 15+ Years Scaling Organic Growth Systems

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Summary

15+ years building organic growth systems where templates, structured data, and search-intent mapping replace manual page production. From wiki-style entity pages at Youdao Dictionary (10K → 200K DAU), to **1.5M POI landing pages** at eLong (~9× non-brand organic orders over 4 years, ~20–30M RMB net profit in the best year), to a **global SEO middle platform** at Alibaba (long-tail non-brand organic < 1K → 200K UV/day, 99.97% of indexed pages found to not earn their existence), to **GEO / AEO** customer-acquisition on Doubao and other AI assistants today — the through-line is the same: programmatic SEO and content engineering, not manual operation.

Hands-on with the full technical SEO stack — GSC + log file analysis, Screaming Frog, Ahrefs, SEMrush, GA4 + BigQuery — plus self-built crawlers, log parsers, sitemap generators, and schema pipelines for problems off-the-shelf tools don't reach. Comfortable reading HTML/CSS, reviewing CDN and JS-rendering decisions with engineering, and shipping JSON-LD, hreflang, canonicalization, and Core Web Vitals work in production. Now extending the same engineering mindset to LLM-powered search (AI Overviews, answer engines, generative search).

Core Skills

Technical SEO: Crawl/render/index, log file analysis, Core Web Vitals, JSON-LD structured data, hreflang, canonicalization, redirect strategy, site migrations, sitemap & robots architecture

Programmatic SEO at Scale: Template-driven million-page generation, search-intent → page-archetype mapping, entity-based SEO, topical authority, internal linking architecture

AEO / GEO: Brand visibility & acquisition on Doubao and other AI assistants; AI-Overview / answer-engine / generative-search optimization

Documentation & Developer Content: Wiki/dictionary-pattern IA, developer-intent content roadmaps, search-driven information architecture

SEO Tooling: Google Search Console, Screaming Frog, Ahrefs, SEMrush, GA4, BigQuery, log analysis; self-built crawlers, schema pipelines, sitemap generators, internal-link auditors

Web Fundamentals: HTML/CSS review for SEO issues, HTTP status codes, CDN configuration, DNS, JS-rendered site indexing

Experimentation: Large-scale A/B and multivariate testing, causal evaluation, statistical-significance discipline

Cross-Functional Leadership: Engineering × content × data science × product marketing; influencing platform and infrastructure decisions

Experience

AI Growth Lead (GEO / Content / Growth Products), Leading Automotive Platform May 2026 – present

Owning customer acquisition and brand visibility across AI assistants (GEO/AEO), content marketing, and growth-product infrastructure (landing pages, attribution, postback).

- **GEO / AEO:** Building the customer-acquisition and brand-visibility system on **Doubao and other AI assistants** — covering both product build-out and day-to-day operation. One of the few production GEO programs in market.
- **Content marketing at scale:** AI + self-built matrix-account system producing intent-targeted content that meets users at search and answer-engine surfaces.
- **Growth-product infrastructure:** Landing-page systems, attribution, postback — the technical foundation behind all organic and paid acquisition.
- **AI Performance Ads** (secondary): Designed an AI-driven ad system that handles million-RMB-monthly creative generation, launch, budget allocation, and performance accounting 24/7 — humans approve only irreversible actions.

Head of Growth (Domestic + International), Cheetah Mobile

Feb 2025 – May 2026

Owned organic + paid acquisition, GEO middle-platform build-out, and lead-gen automation across domestic and international business.

- **Led GEO middle-platform build-out** — improved brand visibility across Doubao and other AI assistants and closed the attribution loop. Supports three business lines; **GEO contribution to orders grew from 10% → 50%**.
- Built '**user scenario → intent keyword → AI categorization → dedicated landing page**' system — programmatic SEO + paid acquisition fused. Overall ad efficiency **+3×**, MQL volume **+3.6×**.
- Reverse-engineered user profiles, pain points, and selling points from sales and usage data, driving **MQL +260%**.
- Built sales-signal feedback mechanism and competitor-channel mapping; **non-paid leads +100%**, lead cost **-15-40%**.

Head of Growth — Subscription Content (International Markets), TouchShort Media July 2024 – Jan 2025 (Chongqing)

Full-funnel growth for an overseas short-drama app; built 0 → scalable user-acquisition system.

- User-profile-driven landing-page and content restructuring lifted **ROI by 30%**.
- Multilingual localization content pipeline — dramatically improved content supply efficiency across markets.

User Growth Leader (SEA), Lazada (Alibaba Group)

Mar 2022 – Feb 2024

User growth, organic content distribution, and ad operations across Southeast Asia — multi-country, multi-language, multi-culture.

- **Re-architected content and SKU distribution logic around user location and real-time intent — conversion rate +50%**. Profile-based distribution lifted CR by 8–13% in Fashion and Beauty.
- Extracted **100 high-frequency reusable scenarios** from 13M behavior records — multi-country, multi-locale intent framework for scaled content production.
- UX and path redesign: new-user registration **+16%**, first-order conversion **+15–20%**.
- Introduced AI-generated selling-point and scenario creatives — selling-point assets accounted for **90% of spend**, nearly replacing manual creative.
- Ran million-USD controlled A/B experiments with budget held flat: **buyer count +20%** vs. team benchmark of 2%, winning 70% incremental budget.

Senior Traffic Growth Expert — SEO Middle Platform, Alibaba (China)

Aug 2017 – Sept 2019

Built a **global e-commerce SEO middle platform** supporting AliExpress, Alibaba.com, Taobao Overseas, and other global businesses for organic growth — covering hreflang, canonicalization, internal-linking, and schema at multi-country scale.

- **The diagnosis most teams miss.** AliExpress and Alibaba.com had ~5–6 billion indexed pages each. Counting only the pages that actually drive business outcomes (orders on AliExpress, quote requests on Alibaba.com — B2B has no orders), only **~0.03–0.04% earned their existence** — the rest were diluting crawl budget and drowning out the good content. Previous long-tail SEO work had *added* pages, which made the problem worse.
- **Phase 1 — content convergence.** On AliExpress, buyer-side and seller-side product detail pages were both indexed. Removed the redundant set. **Long-tail organic traffic went up ~70K UV/day almost immediately** — a 7× lift on the metric that mattered, with no new content. Sometimes the answer to "more traffic" is "fewer pages."
- **Phase 2 — the SEO middle platform.** Built shared infrastructure — hreflang, canonicalization, schema, sitemaps, internal linking at platform scale — for AliExpress, Alibaba.com, and Taobao Overseas. The principle generalized: stop building parallel per-market systems; build one platform that does it right and every site benefits.
- **Results.** Reversed multi-year organic-traffic decline. Long-tail non-brand organic on AliExpress / Alibaba.com went from < 1,000 UV/day to ~200,000 UV/day. Taobao Overseas long-tail added ~150K UV/day. **Saved 90%+ headcount** vs. the per-market, per-team model. Full-funnel UX optimization lifted organic conversion rate by 10%.

Online Marketing Director — SEO / SEM, eLong (under Expedia; acquired by Ctrip / Aug 2012 – Aug 2017 Trip.com in 2017)

Owned scalable organic and paid acquisition for one of China's largest OTAs — non-brand programmatic SEO plus SEM automation at platform scale.

- **Programmatic SEO at scale**: built a **1.5M-POI landing-page system** from Gaode / Baidu map data + eLong's own hotel inventory. One templated page form covering every POI type (airports, hospitals, attractions, transit hubs, businesses); each page answered the traveler decision journey — how to get there, local services within 5km, ≥3 bookable hotels nearby with an interactive map. **~9x growth in non-brand organic orders over 4 years** (2x, 2x, 1.5x, 1.5x), contributing **20–30M RMB annual net profit in the best year**. Internal linking built as opportunities arose: city pages → key POIs; hotel detail pages → nearby POIs.
- **Quality gate, not vibes**: ship-or-not for a POI was the **≥3-bookable-hotels-within-5km rule** — a real business-value condition, not a search-volume threshold. Of 15–20M raw map POIs, the system shipped 1.5M, with ~90% indexed.
- **Discipline signal**: built a 150K-UV/day intracity transit-routes feature, then closed it directly — OTA earned on hotels only, this had zero business value. No escalation needed.
- **SEM automation platform**: replaced a 15-person manual operation with a Ruby on Rails platform and a unified search-engine API abstraction. Steady-state **20M keywords** across Baidu / 360 / Sogou / Soso (now defunct) / Shenma (mobile-only). ROI-based bid adjustment, budget pacing, automated landing-page routing, and Hive-based attribution joining spend to order value at the keyword level. **ROI +50%** vs. the manual baseline; transparent spend-vs-profit became a default view.
- Team evolved from 1 SEO operator + 5 editors to 5 engineers, 0 SEO operators, 0 editors — manual content production was the wrong shape for the page volume needed.

SEO Engineer — Dictionary, Translation, News, Auto, NetEase Youdao

Feb 2011 – Aug 2012

Organic-traffic growth across Youdao Dictionary, Youdao Translation, NetEase News, and NetEase Auto.

- **Entity-based SEO for Youdao Dictionary**: built wiki-style terminology pages structured around real user search journeys (people looking up terms in their own field of work or study). **Search-engine DAU 10K → 180–200K**. Same pattern that today's developer-documentation SEO uses.
- Translation product brand traffic **+100%**.
- Awarded **Best Employee 4 months after joining**.

Co-Founder / Growth Lead, Global Procurement Database Startup (Overseas)

Sept 2019 – Mar 2022

- User acquisition and high-value-user identification for US/EU markets.
- Built a user-mapping algorithm with 50% data overlap against the top competitor; delivered a high-value lead system supporting sales directly.

Development Lead, Sina Real Estate (Leju)

Jan 2008 – Jan 2011

- Grew from software engineer to development lead. Built and automated SEO and content distribution systems — the technical foundation under everything that came after. Hands-on HTML/CSS, server-side rendering, and crawl-friendly architecture.

Technical Support Engineer, PeopleCert (Greece)

Jan 2007 – Jan 2008

- Software testing and debugging; on-site technical support for enterprise clients across Europe.

Education

Beijing Jiaotong University, BSc in Information and Computing Science

2002 – 2006